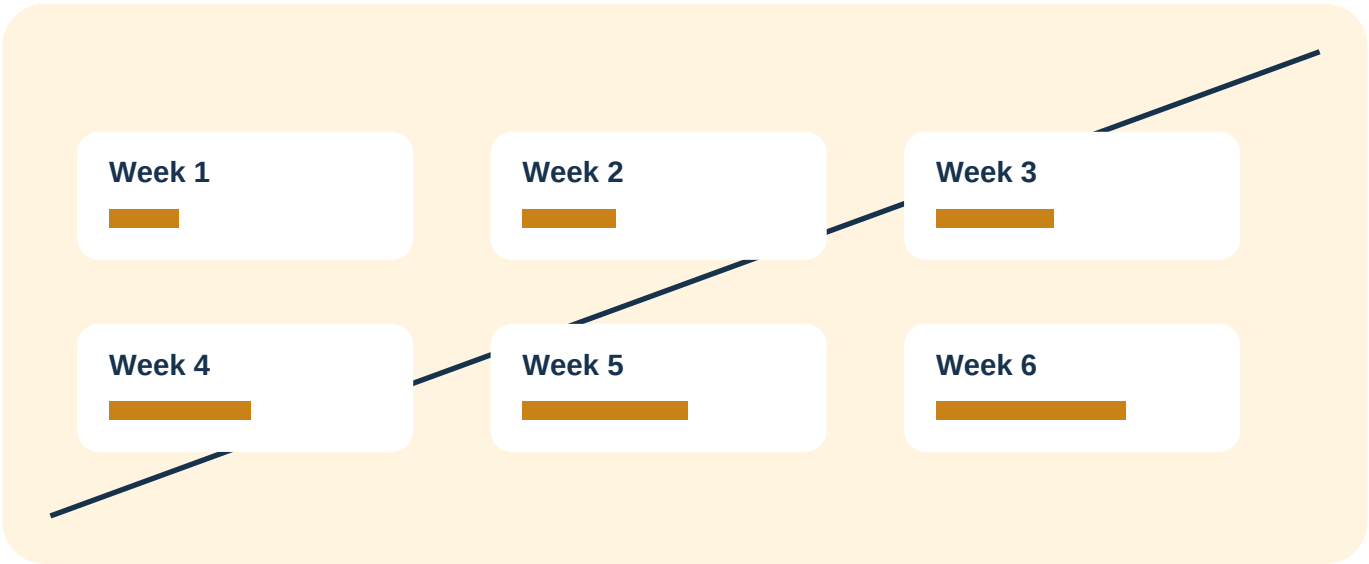


ANL559 Instructor Pre-Class Companion

Private teaching notes for releasing student briefs and planning the in-class reveal.

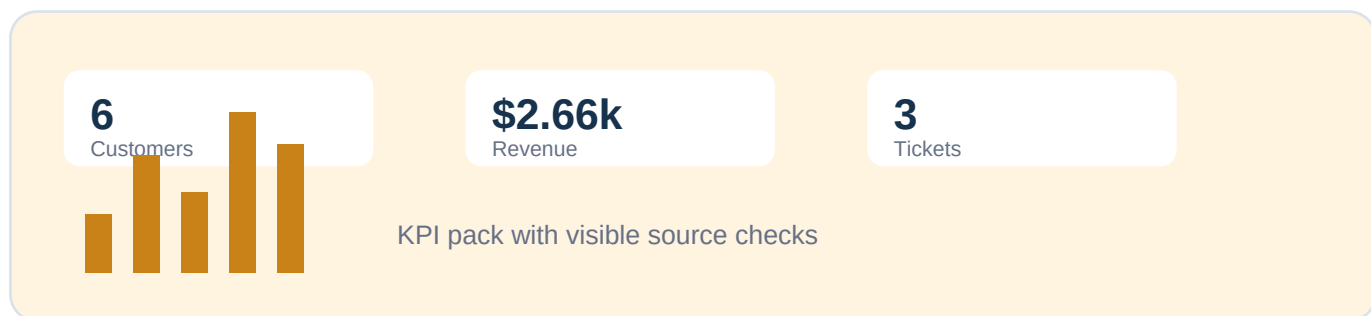


Northstar Retail case sequence

Use this companion as the private teaching map for release timing, reveal points, likely misconceptions, and in-class framing.

Instructor Week 1 - Reporting Fire Drill

The Monday KPI pack is due, but the usual analyst is away.



Instructor framing

Students should arrive thinking about business definitions, source files, and traceability before they learn the agent-supervision workflow.

Release Before Class

Release the student brief and the four Week 1 sample files. Do not release the exercise sheet or worked examples before class.

Keep Private Until Class

- Do not reveal the expected smoke-check values before the activity.
- Do not reveal the active-customer denominator trap.
- Do not show the generated dashboard or KPI report until the demonstration point.

In-Class Reveal Points

- The approved active-customer KPI is paid active accounts, not recent login.
- The known sample checks are paid active accounts 6, recent-login customers 7, gross June revenue 2860, net June revenue 2660, and open support tickets 3.
- The main teachable contrast is plausible output versus checked output.

What To Watch For

- Students may treat every login as active customer status.
- Students may report gross revenue when the stakeholder expects net revenue.
- Students may focus on a polished report before checking definitions.

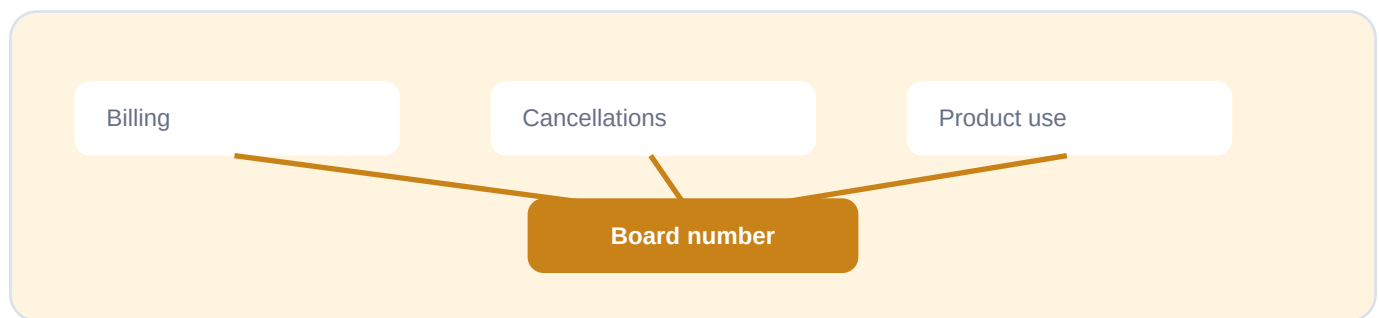
Student Brief Summary

Student-facing data/materials listed for pre-class reading:

File or material	What it contains
week1_customers.csv	Customer records, subscription status, plan type, login date, and paid status.
week1_sales.csv	June order records, gross amount, and refund amount.
week1_support.csv	Support ticket records, open/closed dates, and severity.
week1_metric_definitions.md	Business definitions for the weekly KPI pack.

Instructor Week 2 - The Board Number Is Wrong

Finance and Product both have churn numbers in the board pack, and they do not match.



Instructor framing

Students should enter class aware that different operational systems can produce different but defensible business views.

Release Before Class

Release only the student brief and the three source files. Keep reconciliation report templates and worked examples for class.

Keep Private Until Class

- Do not reveal the row-count bridge or quarantine-table language in advance.
- Do not reveal which customer IDs are intentionally mismatched.
- Do not name inner joins as the main risk before class.

In-Class Reveal Points

- Subscriptions has 10 rows, cancellations has 3 rows, and product events has 9 rows.
- C204 appears in subscription/cancellation data but has no product event.
- C999 appears in product events but not in subscriptions.
- The teachable point is not one perfect churn number; it is the reconciliation logic.

What To Watch For

- Students may assume the largest table is the source of truth.
- Students may want to delete unmatched records to make a clean table.
- Students may miss the difference between billing churn and product inactivity.

Student Brief Summary

Student-facing data/materials listed for pre-class reading:

File or material	What it contains
week2_subscriptions.csv	Subscription plan, billing status, billing start date, and billing end date.
week2_cancellations.csv	Cancellation request date, billing end date, and cancellation reason.
week2_product_events.csv	Recent product activity by customer, including sessions and active feature count.

Instructor Week 3 - Limited Retention Budget

The business can contact only a limited number of customers.

All customers

Customers needing review

Limited contact capacity

Instructor framing

Students should arrive with decision-policy thinking rather than model-metric thinking.

Release Before Class

Release the student brief and data file. Keep leakage audit, baseline guidance, and threshold economics for class.

Keep Private Until Class

- Do not reveal the leakage columns in advance.
- Do not reveal the break-even calculation in the pre-class material.
- Do not name top-N or threshold policy language before the activity.

In-Class Reveal Points

- `post_offer_response` is post-decision information and should not be used as a predictor.
- `retained_next_month` is the outcome, not a decision-time feature.
- Offer cost is 25 and expected saved margin is 120, giving a 20.8 percent break-even save rate.

What To Watch For

- Students may ask for the best model before defining the decision.
- Students may use outcome or post-offer fields because they look useful.
- Students may ignore capacity and cost.

Student Brief Summary

Student-facing data/materials listed for pre-class reading:

File or material	What it contains
week3_retention_training.csv	Customer-level data about tenure, monthly fee, usage, support tickets, plan type, discounts, offer response, and next-month retention.

Instructor Week 4 - From Notebook To Tool

Operations wants something usable, not a notebook that only one analyst can run.

User input

Internal tool

Recommendation

Instructor framing

Students should arrive thinking about user needs, inputs, outputs, and operational handoff.

Release Before Class

Release the student brief only. Keep input-contract templates, bad-input tests, and runbook examples for class.

Keep Private Until Class

- Do not reveal the specific validation rules in advance.
- Do not reveal the handoff-test structure.
- Do not show the runbook template before the exercise begins.

In-Class Reveal Points

- The internal tool must reject missing customer_id, negative tenure, unknown plan type, and missing usage/support data.
- A tool is not ready simply because a happy-path request works.
- The operating evidence is the input contract, bad-request behaviour, tests, and runbook.

What To Watch For

- Students may design a dashboard without defining who uses it.
- Students may ignore bad or missing input.
- Students may assume the original author will always operate the tool.

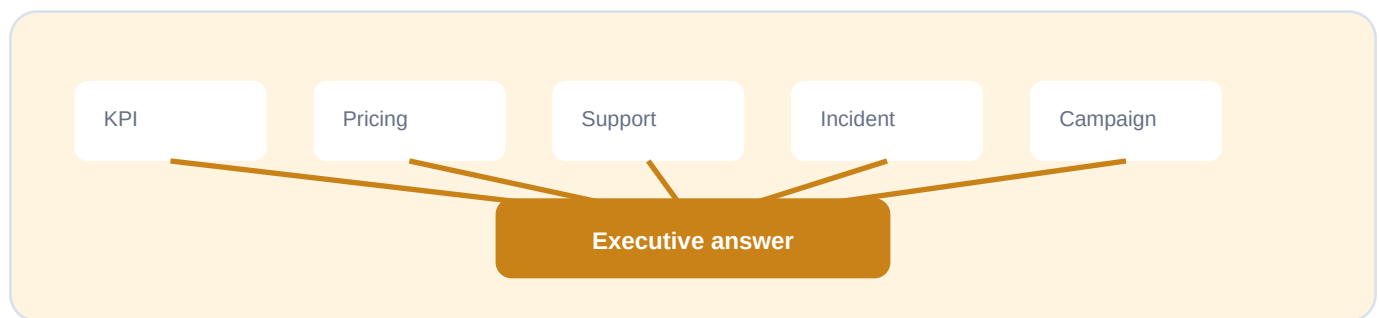
Student Brief Summary

Student-facing data/materials listed for pre-class reading:

File or material	What it contains
Week 3 decision context	Customer-prioritisation logic or notes from the previous week.
Suggested request format	Customer ID, tenure, fee, usage, support tickets, and plan type.

Instructor Week 5 - The Executive Question

The CEO wants to know why churn changed in June.



Instructor framing

Students should arrive with a first executive explanation and a sense of uncertainty, before learning the evaluation harness.

Release Before Class

Release the student brief and the knowledge base only. Keep evaluation cases for class.

Keep Private Until Class

- Do not release week5_eval_cases.csv before class.
- Do not pre-teach citation support checks.
- Do not identify the refusal cases before the activity.

In-Class Reveal Points

- The evidence supports the observed churn pattern and a plausible onboarding-friction investigation.
- The evidence does not support a confident causal claim that the May price change caused June churn.
- The campaign started too late to support a full-month June churn claim.

What To Watch For

- Students may mistake a source mention for evidence support.
- Students may use causal language too quickly.
- Students may write a fluent answer without naming uncertainty.

Student Brief Summary

Student-facing data/materials listed for pre-class reading:

File or material	What it contains
week5_knowledge_base.md	Short internal source notes about churn, pricing, support, product incidents, and marketing activity.

Instructor Week 6 - Launch Review

The launch committee wants a recommendation, not a feature tour.



Evidence

Scope

Owner

Launch recommendation

Instructor framing

Students should arrive with evidence and judgement, not just demo material.

Release Before Class

Release the student brief only. Keep launch checklist, incident injects, and viva prompts for class.

Keep Private Until Class

- Do not reveal the incident injects before class.
- Do not release the launch checklist as a completed structure.
- Do not frame full launch as the expected answer.

In-Class Reveal Points

- A limited pilot or no-ship recommendation can be strong if evidence and ownership are clear.
- Incident response should pause, narrow, or redirect the launch claim when evidence fails.
- The final defence is about scope, owner, evidence, and no-ship conditions.

What To Watch For

- Students may turn the session into a feature tour.
- Students may hide weak evidence instead of scoping the recommendation.
- Students may name the system or agent as owner rather than a human role.

Student Brief Summary

Student-facing data/materials listed for pre-class reading:

File or material	What it contains
Week 1 reporting work	KPI reporting artefact, definitions, and checks.
Week 2 reconciliation work	Notes on conflicting numbers and source comparison.
Week 3 retention work	Customer-prioritisation or decision notes.
Week 4 internal tool work	Notes on user inputs, outputs, and operating needs.
Week 5 executive answer work	Evidence-based answer and source notes.